2 Site and Environmental Planning

2.1 Burwood's Planning Context

The broad physical context of Burwood is provided by its location in the Cumberland Basin, on the southern side of the Parramatta River. The majority of Burwood, located to the north of Liverpool Road, drains towards the Parramatta River, while land to the south slopes toward the Cooks River.

Most of Burwood comprises gently undulating land in low ridges and valleys, with elevations up to 48m near Liverpool Road and Culdees Road, and down to 4m along the Cooks River in the south, and Parramatta Road opposite Concord Oval in the north. The topography of Burwood provides significant urban views and vistas.

Burwood's urban geography is dictated by its close proximity to Sydney City, and location astride the main early transport routes of Parramatta Road the Great Western Railway. These have meant a long history of settlement since the colonial era. Early semi-rural development and gentleman's residences were succeeded in the early 20th Century by high quality suburban housing on medium sized allotments, supported by retail and service centres at key nodes and along the major roads.

Widespread densification of Inner Sydney in the years post World War II saw growth in medium-rise housing in specific parts of Burwood, especially around the main rail transport nodes. The majority of Burwood however has remained low density residential, with extensive high quality areas and numerous residential heritage items. There is little native bushland remaining in Burwood.

The Burwood Town Centre (BTC) emerged early as a natural centre of the Inner West for public transport access, retail and commercial services, employment and in recent decades for medium and high density housing. In successive Metropolitan Strategies, the BTC has been flagged for growth as the Inner West's Major Centre (later termed a Strategic Centre).

According to the Burwood Local Strategic Planning Statement, Burwood's estimated residential population was 39,886 people in 2018. Burwood's population is highly multicultural, with 57% of the population born overseas in 2016. The Burwood Town Centre has many areas where over 80% of the population were born overseas. There were 18,970 local jobs in the Burwood LGA in 2017.

Burwood's residents, workers and visitors enjoy a high quality urban environment with many attractive streetscapes and substantial parks. Burwood's main environmental challenges are associated with its location in the Sydney, including traffic congestion, air quality, ecological sustainability, and the potential impacts of global warming.

The planning context for the Burwood LGA therefore has the following key features that are supported by this DCP:

- Housing availability and diversity.
- Excellent accessibility with good transport connections.
- Availability of major shopping facilities, business services and community facilities.
- High quality urban environment and public domains of residential and commercial areas.
- Heritage conservation and healthy communities.
- Economic development and local employment opportunities.
- Sustainable development and environmental protection.
- Protection of Burwood's high quality residential areas.

2.2 General Site Analysis

The physical, environmental and social features of Burwood and its development history significantly affect the nature and scale of development. It is essential to respond to the local and broader contexts by identifying the defining elements of a development site and the character of the locality.

As a first step in preparing for a development, a site analysis should be undertaken at an appropriate scale. This should identify the opportunities and constraints of the site, taking into account the existing planning framework. Together these should create a platform from which to develop a design. A site analysis demonstrates that the proposed development is the best possible solution and makes the best contribution to its surroundings. It also shows measures to mitigate identified adverse impacts.

All Development Applications should prepare and submit a site analysis, except Development Applications for the purposes of:

Change of use

Minor alterations and additions, and

Swimming pools.

The degree of detail required in a general site analysis will vary according to the nature, type and scale of the development and its planning context. The site analysis may include some or all of the elements in Table 1, and the level of detail required should be clarified with Council's development assessment officers. The analysis may comprise plans, sketches, photographs and supporting written information.

Table 1. Site Analysis Details

Identifying Information:
▪ Scale and north point.
▪ Date.
Property Details:
▪ Site dimensions, property boundaries and site area.
▪ Easements for drainage, services and rights of carriageway.
Landform and Vegetation:
▪ Spot levels and contours.
▪ Differences in ground levels on site as well as between the site and adjoining properties.
▪ Existing vegetation on/or affecting the site, location, height, canopy cover and species types.
▪ Important views - from the site and from adjoining land.
▪ Identification of any contaminated soils on the site and extent of any known landfill.
▪ Landscape features - rock outcrops, embankments, retaining walls.
▪ Soil type and depth.
▪ Flood liable land, existing means of stormwater drainage, existing stormwater detention systems, flow paths, drainage easements and watercourses and channels etc.
▪ Sun and shade characteristics.
▪ Prevailing winds.
Access:
▪ Vehicle and pedestrian access to and from the site.
▪ Public roads, laneways and pathways.
▪ On corner sites, the provision of a splay corner if required by Council.

▪ Driveways, parking areas, loading bays on the site and within the vicinity of the site.
▪ Existing cycle facilities within the area.
▪ Public transport services.
Existing Development:
▪ Existing buildings - on the site and on adjoining land. Show location, distance from the boundary, height and current use. Include elevations showing adjacent buildings.
▪ Existing neighbourhood character, including the pattern of development, built form, building materials and colours, fencing and garden styles.
▪ Direction and distances to local shops, schools, public transport, parks, community facilities and local activity centres.
▪ Overshadowing of and by adjoining buildings.
▪ Fences and walls location, height and materials.
▪ Swimming pools and slipways.
▪ Privacy - adjoining private open spaces, doors and windows.
▪ Street frontage features - poles, trees, kerbs, footpaths, crossings and street furniture.
▪ Noise, odour and light spillage sources (e.g. main roads, railway lines, sports fields, air conditioning units, pool pumps and industrial areas).
▪ Heritage and/or archaeological features on site and in the vicinity of the site include landscapes, buildings, conservation areas and special character areas.
▪ Existing advertising signs.

Other parts of this DCP may have more detailed requirements for site analysis for specific locations or forms of development.

2.3 Views and Vistas

Burwood's regional location and gentle topography result in mainly urban and local views and vistas. These are an important part of sense of place, amenity and character in the Burwood LGA. They warrant special attention for inclusion in the site analysis and in the formulation of development proposals.

Views and vistas include cityscapes, streetscapes, open space and parks, significant and landmark buildings, and horizons and ridgelines. From higher commercial and residential buildings, views and vistas can be more encompassing and over greater distances.

Objectives

O1 To preserve and enhance significant views and vistas within the Burwood LGA.

O2 To encourage view sharing through complementary siting of buildings, responsive design and appropriate landscaping.

O3 To ensure highly visible developments are located and designed in scale with Burwood's cityscapes in the context of applicable planning controls.

Provisions

P1 Development applications must identify existing views and vistas significant to the proposal, assess the impacts of the development and demonstrate how significant views and vistas are to be protected and enhanced.

P2 Development applications must demonstrate how building design, location and landscaping will encourage view sharing between properties.

P3 Assessment of views and vistas must take account of other planning policies and development standards in this DCP and the BLEP 2012, e.g. building height, setbacks.

P4 Developments must have particular regard to high quality and priority views and vistas identified in other parts of this DCP, e.g. in relation to heritage items and heritage conservation areas.

Advisory Note:
For certain developments, photo montages from selected locations may be required to demonstrate how the proposal affects views and vistas.

2.4 Streetscapes

Streetscape represents the inter-relationship between buildings, landscape and open spaces in the street scene. The quality of the streetscape impacts on local amenity and identity. Streetscape qualities include building form, scale, materials and colours that contribute to the overall character of the local area.

Streetscapes therefore warrant special attention for inclusion in the site analysis and in the formulation of development proposals.

Objectives

O1 To ensure new development responds to, reinforces and sensitively relates to the spatial characteristics of the existing urban environment.

O2 To increase the legibility of streetscapes and urban spaces so that the inter-relationship between development, landscape and open space is visually coherent and harmonious.

O3 To maximise opportunities for buildings to define the public domain.

O4 To encourage attractive street frontages and improve pedestrian amenity.

Provisions

P1 Development applications must identify streetscape characteristics, assess the impacts of the development and demonstrate how significant streetscape qualities are to be protected and enhanced.

P2 Development applications must demonstrate how building design, location and landscaping will encourage the protection and enhancements of streetscapes.

P3 Developments must have particular regard to high quality streetscapes identified in other parts of this DCP, e.g. in relation to heritage items and conservation areas.

Advisory Note:
For certain developments, photo montages from selected locations may be required to demonstrate how the proposal affects streetscapes.